

Manar Attar

AI Engineer | Agentic Systems | NLP

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Summary

AI engineer who ships products end to end, from the first idea to a live, deployed system. Specialised in agentic AI products: chatbots and assistants that search, reason and act on real data, voice agents, and workflows in which several agents cooperate, all built with grounding, evaluation and guardrails. Works across the whole stack, from models and retrieval to the backend and the interface, and has taken a range of products live.

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, SQL, JavaScript, PHP, R

LLM & NLP: OpenAI API, Gemini API, GPT-4o and GPT-4o-mini, Ollama (Llama 3.1, Qwen3), Hugging Face Transformers, tool calling, RAG, embeddings and semantic search, ChromaDB, prompt engineering, agentic AI, agent orchestration, MCP, Whisper (STT), ElevenLabs (TTS)

ML & Data: PyTorch, scikit-learn, pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, seaborn

Web & Infra: FastAPI, Flask, Laravel, Livewire, Next.js, React, Vite, Tailwind CSS, SQLAlchemy, Pydantic, REST and SSE APIs, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Firebase, Docker, Linux server deployment (Caddy), Git, Vercel, Render

Languages: English (Fluent), Arabic (Native), Dutch (B2)

Work Experience

AI Engineer | Vervai

Apr 2024 to Present

- Built several AI agents and end to end AI solutions for client engagements: custom LLM applications, conversational assistants, and retrieval systems over proprietary document collections, alongside workflow automation.
- Scoped the highest impact use cases with clients and took them from concept to production.
- Ran practical AI workshops that upskill client teams.

Innovation Consultant | Daffee

Jun 2024 to Sep 2025

- Built four GPT assistants tailored to marketing, sales, operations and leadership that accelerated daily workflows and decision making.
- Designed partly automated workflows that removed repetitive manual work and freed teams for higher value tasks.

Education

MA Language & AI | Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Sep 2025 to Dec 2026 (expected)

- Specialisation in NLP, large language models, data annotation and cross dataset evaluation. Thesis passed.

Amsterdam Startup Launch Program | Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Sep 2024 to Jan 2025

- Intensive entrepreneurship program on validating business concepts with the Business Model Canvas.

BSc Artificial Intelligence | Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Sep 2020 to Aug 2023

- Foundations of AI, machine learning, statistics and hypothesis testing. Minor in Data Science (NLP and text analysis).

Master's Thesis

Author Profiling of Hate Speech Spreaders

MA Thesis, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, 2026

- **Question.** Can the age and gender of hate speech authors be inferred from their writing, and does training on general social media transfer?
- **Method.** Compared zero shot LLMs (LLaMA-3.1-8B, Qwen3-32B) with BERT, HateBERT and RoBERTa fine tuned on PAN14 (11,906 text chunks), evaluated on 619 English Facebook comments from LiLaH-HAG, against majority class and random baselines.
- **Results.** Gender: zero shot LLaMA reached a macro F1 of 0.515 against 0.488 for the best encoder and a 0.418 majority baseline. Age: the best encoder, BERT, reached 0.310 against 0.211 for the best LLM. The oldest group (66+, 10.3% of the test set) was almost never identified by any model. Neither approach is reliable enough for deployment, and the better one depends on the attribute.
- **Analysis.** Confusion matrix and lexical error analysis suggest the domain as a likely ceiling: hate speech is a narrow, conventionalised register whose shared vocabulary leaves little individual style to separate demographic groups.
- **Extension.** Extended the study to Slovene with CroSloEngual BERT, where grammatical gender marking gives a morphological cue, gender macro F1 reached 0.609, 9.4 points above the best English result, suggesting that language specific cues can matter more than model size.

Products

Hajzi: Restaurant Booking Platform with an AI Dining Assistant

hajzi.me

- Built a bilingual Arabic and English platform for restaurant discovery, table booking and QR table ordering, with vendor and admin dashboards and booking transactions that prevent double booking. (Laravel, Livewire, Filament, MySQL, Docker)
- Built Ask Hajzi, a Gemini powered chatbot with tool calling and embeddings based semantic search over 800+ venues and their menus. It answers questions about restaurants and menus and guides diners through the booking journey, with grounded, checked replies.

ARGUS: Agentic Risk Governance and Understanding System

argus.manarattar.com

- Built an eight step agentic workflow that investigates a corporate counterparty case file: it extracts evidence tied to source documents, tests each finding against internal policy, and runs an adversarial agent that argues against its own conclusions.
- Kept trust in deterministic code rather than the model: verbatim quote verification, citations as checked identifiers, an arithmetic risk score, and a review gate that no code path can complete without a recorded human decision.
- Shipped with a 53 case evaluation suite and a keyless demo mode that replays recorded model responses while every deterministic layer still runs. (FastAPI, Next.js, PostgreSQL, pgvector, Docker)

Reel Replies: Instagram Comment to Reply and DM Automation

- Built and run a live Instagram automation service: a keyword in a Reel comment triggers a public reply and a private DM, chosen from rotating variants by a rules engine.
- Handles verified Meta webhooks, a rate limited persistent send queue, delivery status tracking, automatic token refresh and an admin dashboard.
- Packaged as a reusable template with 38 tests and an 11 chapter setup guide, so others can deploy it on a free tier. (FastAPI, Meta Graph API, Postgres, Docker)

TelecomNL Voice AI Assistant

voice.manarattar.com

- Built a bilingual (Dutch and English) voice agent with Whisper speech to text, GPT-4o reasoning and ElevenLabs speech synthesis, covering 10 telecom issue categories and 8 customer profiles.
- Added a live dashboard for intent, sentiment and confidence, with rule based and LLM based escalation and automatic handoff summaries. (FastAPI, GPT-4o, ElevenLabs, Whisper, WebSocket)

AI Contract Risk Analyzer

contracts.manarattar.com

- Built a RAG assistant with per clause risk scoring (0 to 100), suggested revisions and missing clause detection across PDF, DOCX and TXT uploads, plus source grounded Q&A and one click PDF reports. (FastAPI, ChromaDB, OpenAI, React)

Multi Agent Research Assistant

researcher.manarattar.com

- Engineered a five agent pipeline (coordinator, search, analysis, fact check, synthesis) that produces structured, citation backed research reports, streaming each agent's progress live, with follow up Q&A grounded in the report sources. (FastAPI, OpenAI, Tavily, SSE, React)

Munazara: AI Debate Engine

munazara.manarattar.com

- Designed a live debate platform where three agents (PRO, CON and Judge) argue in structured rounds with retrieved evidence and real time fact checking. The judge reads the full debate and returns a weighted scorecard with a margin and confidence level.
- Added a user versus AI mode, voting and an interactive knowledge graph linking every debate. (FastAPI, gpt-4o-mini, Tavily, ChromaDB, React, SSE)

RivalScan: Competitor Intelligence Dashboard

rivals.manarattar.com

- Automated competitor tracking across RSS feeds, GitHub releases and changelogs, summarising each update with AI and scoring it by business impact. (FastAPI, OpenAI, SQLAlchemy, React, Vite)

SwipeEat: Swipe Driven Restaurant Ordering

swipeat.manarattar.com

- Built a restaurant ordering product with a preference based meal recommender, digital menu, QR table sessions, live order tracking, a kitchen display and an admin dashboard. (Python, Flask, PostgreSQL, JavaScript)

Academic Projects

LINKED4RESILIENCE: Geo Data Integration for Crisis Response

- Built data pipelines for cleaning, processing and visualising geo annotated crisis datasets, and applied Linked Data methods with an algorithm for data unification and integration. Published at the 31st ACM SIGSPATIAL International Conference (2023). (Python, RDF, SPARQL, Ontology, Linked Data)

Emotion and Sentiment Analysis (Human Language Technology)

- Built sentiment and emotion classification models with optimised SVMs and TF-IDF features on conversational and social media text, with error analysis of trade offs under class imbalance. (Python, NLP, SVM, scikit-learn)

Publications

- **M. Attar** (first author), S. Wang, R. Siebes, E. Kultorp (2023). *Converting and Enriching Geoannotated Event Data: Integrating Information for Ukraine Resilience*. 31st ACM SIGSPATIAL International Conference, Nov 13 to 16, 2023.
- **M. Attar** (first author), S. Wang, R. Siebes, E. Kultorp (2023). *Using Integrated and Enriched Linked Data for Ukraine Resilience*. BNAIC 2023 Conference, Nov 8 to 10, 2023.

References

Dr. Shuai Wang, Bachelor's Thesis Supervisor and publication coauthor, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Raihan Karim, Business Partner and Academic Collaborator across academic projects and entrepreneurial ventures